



Diversity and Inclusion

A diverse and inclusive workplace makes for a more successful business. Recruit from a wider pool of talented people and create an environment where all are welcome and appreciated and more likely to enjoy their work and contribute.

What is diversity?

Diversity extends beyond considerations of race, gender, and disability. More broadly, it encompasses all the characteristics or qualities that make a person different from yourself. When recruiting, there is a subconscious tendency to look for people who are like you, so pay attention to diversity to help you move away from that bias and think more openly.

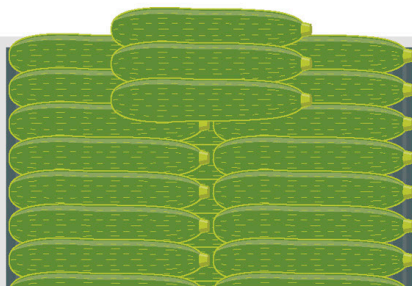
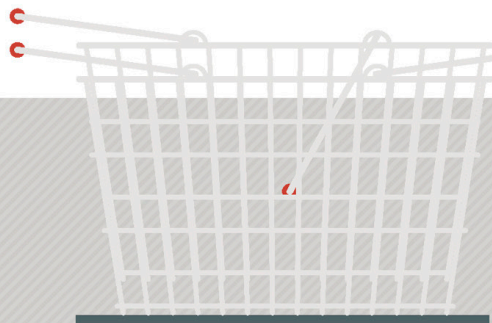
This is not just to ensure legal compliance: firms that embrace diversity are likely to be more profitable, so it is good business sense to have a welcoming outlook and reflect the globally connected marketplace.

Research carried out by US management consultants McKinsey & Co. showed that diverse businesses are more successful at winning top talent, score higher on employee satisfaction, have a deeper understanding of their customers, and are better at decision-making.

Diversity is about recruiting and doing business with a broader range of people, while inclusion involves sustaining an open and welcoming work atmosphere. A new business needs to strive to promote an inclusive culture, where people feel safe to make suggestions, without worrying how their views will be received.

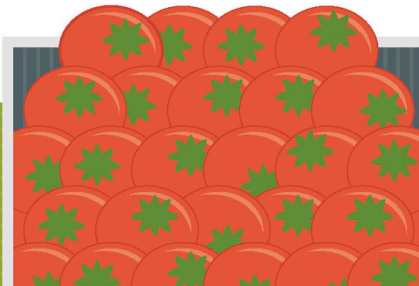
Why diversity matters

Encouraging diversity brings many benefits to a business. Not only will your firm be able to draw on a wider pool of talent with fresh ideas, but it will also be in a better position to connect with a range of customers. A diverse company will also have a better understanding of the wants and needs of that wider audience.



STRATEGIES

Set in place a plan to encourage diversity from recruitment to onboarding to marketing. Everyone involved must understand the benefits and not see a focus on diversity as merely compliance with the law. Social media used to promote the business should both depict and engage with a wide range of individuals and groups.



BENEFITS

People who think in the same way are likely to come up with a similar, limited range of ideas. Involve a diverse group of people, however, and creativity will soar. Diversity improves innovation as people bring their different perspectives and feel freer to propose original, even unconventional, ideas.